IQMS User Letter 50 – PTC Guidance for Eylea 2mg and 8mg Pre-filled Syringe (PFS)

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Applicable to: Eylea 2 mg prefilled syringes (PFS) / Eylea 8 mg PFS (OcuClick)

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1. Introduction

This User Letter provides guidance in complaint processing for Eylea Prefilled Syringes (PFS); Eylea 2 mg prefilled syringes (PFS) / Eylea 8 mg PFS (OcuClick).

2. Guidance for Data Entry (CQU/GBS)

2.1 Guidance on initial error coding, initial risk classification, sample return and affected Manufacturing Sites

Guidance on initial error coding, initial risk classification, sample return and affected Manufacturing Sites is provided in Table 1. Reported unintentional mishap/accident by user not related to use/handling of the product (e.g. broken due to dropping on floor, bumped on counter), contamination of syringe prior use e.g. due to patient activity (sneezing, coughing, talking) does not qualify as Use Error (UE) as per definitions see GSOP 115 and therefore should not be processed in IQMS.

2.2 Guidance for Intraocular Pressure (IOP)/ Ocular Hypertension AE Cases (CQU/GBS)

If Eylea Prefilled Syringe (PFS) is reported along with an AE related to an increase of intraocular pressure (IOP) / Ocular Hypertension PV may request PTC investigation regardless causality with the PFS to exclude any potential quality defects related to the syringe.
For IOP / Ocular Hypertension cases local PV is following-up with the Reporter / Complainant by applying Eylea PFS follow-up questions. This questionnaire, if available, is forwarded to CQU/GBS along with the request for a PTC initiation and should be attached in IQMS.

2.3 2 mg PFS 'Condensation in the blister' and 'Air bubbles in solution

In accordance with GSOP 115, no investigation is required for usability issues that have been determined as result of Use Errors (UE) and/or Customer Satisfaction Issues (CSI) and are known unconfirmed issues (not applicable if Adverse Event or any other defect is reported along with the UE). Reports related to "condensation in the blister" and "air bubbles in solution" for the 2 mg PFS have been thoroughly investigated for a time period of three years after launch and have been identified to be related to specific usability issue categories.

Therefore, the decision has been made that no further investigation is required for these cases and hence these cases can be processed as UEs or CSIs and can be closed with local closure. The decision leading to the determination of "condensation in the blister" and "air bubbles in solution" as Use Errors is documented in "Eylea PFS 2mg - Condensation & Air bubbles Use Errors".

Note: N/A for 8 mg PFS (OcuClick).

Justification for local Closure: Per Guidance Document. Further guidance on data entry is summarized in Table 2

2.4 Shift of RQU responsibilities to SC Berlin

All Complaints related to Falsification / Counterfeits incidents, Packaging/Labelling and OcuCklick activation issues are directly forwarded to the RQU at SC Berlin.

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Table 1: Guidance on initial error coding, sample/pictures return to Manufacturing Sites (not all inclusive)

Reported Complaints	Level 1	Level 2	Level 3	Picture Required	Sample Return	Initial Risk Class	Manufacturing Site / Where to return Sample
Intraocular pressure (IOP)/ Ocular Hypertension Cases / PV cases							
Increased IOP/Ocular Hypertension reported as AE only	---	---	Adverse event type: Adverse Event / Adverse reaction	No	Yes	Medium [a] or Low	2 mg: BD 8 mg: SCB (RoW) / SC Shiga (J)
Increased IOP/Ocular Hypertension reported along with a handling issue	Syringe	Handling issue	Improper dose setting *or* Instructions not followed *or* Handling error *and/or* Adverse event type: Adverse Event / Adverse reaction	No	Yes	Medium [a] or Low	2 mg: BD 8 mg: SCB (RoW)/ SC Shiga (J)
Endophthalmitis as AE (also described as Vitritis, Edema, Luveitis) or Adverse event without mentioning specific AE to be entered as PTC if reported along with a handling error which could have caused the AE or potential quality issue	Syringe	Handling issue	Instructions not followed *or* Instructions unclear *and/or* Adverse event type: Adverse Event / Adverse reaction	No	Yes (check with RQU where to send sample)	Medium [a] or Low	SCB (RoW)/ SC Shiga (J) /Vetter
PV request e.g. because of signal, cluster or confirmation of quality request (for any AE) Health authority's requests	---	---	Adverse event type: Adverse Event / Adverse reaction	No	Yes (check with RQU where	Medium [a] or Low	SCB (RoW)/ SC Shiga (J) / Vetter

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Reported Complaints	Level 1	Level 2	Level 3	Picture Required	Sample Return	Initial Risk Class	Manufacturing Site / Where to return Sample
					to send sample)		
Packaging, Quantity, and Labeling							
Open secondary pack/ Originality seal damaged	Folding box	Damage	Originality seal damaged *or* Open	Yes	upon RQU request	Low	SCB (RoW) [d] SC Shiga (J) [e]
Damaged package	Folding box	Damage	Breakage *or* Perforation *or* Other	Yes	upon RQU request	Low	SCB (RoW) [d] SC Shiga (J) [e]
Missing Unit in the Pack	Folding box	Quantity	Final product missing in shipping container *or* Finished package incomplete (parts missing)	No	No	Low	SCB (RoW) [d] SC Shiga (J) [e]
Blister received damaged / deformed / open, (lack of sterility of the outer syringe)	Blister	Damage	Open *or* Other	Yes	Yes	Low (Medium if used)	SCB (RoW) [d] SC Shiga (J) [e]
Delamination of Tyvek foil during blister opening	Blister	Appearance/ Product Characteristics	Delamination of foil	Yes	upon RQU request	Low	SCB (RoW) [d] SC Shiga (J) [e]
Low fill: Amount less than usual / low fill (insufficient amount of liquid in PFS to allow priming according to IFU)	Syringe	Quantity	Underfilling in immediate container	Yes	Yes	Low (Medium if syringe intact/ not used)	Vetter

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Reported Complaints	Level 1	Level 2	Level 3	Picture Required	Sample Return	Initial Risk Class	Manufacturing Site / Where to return Sample
Overfill: Amount more than usual	Syringe	Quantity	Overfilling in immediate container	Yes	Yes	Low	Vetter
Label / Peel-off label damaged	Label	Damage	Other	Yes	Yes	Low	SCB (RoW) [d] SC Shiga (J) [e]
8mg: Missing Peel-off label inside of the folding box	Label	Quantity	Finished Package incomplete (parts missing)	Yes	Yes	Low	SCB (RoW) [d] SC Shiga (J) [e]
Label wrongly placed e.g. for 2 mg too close to dose line and for 8 mg difficult to prime	Label	Print/Labelling	Other	Yes	Yes	Low	SCB (RoW) [d] SC Shiga (J) [e]
Contamination							
Contamination e.g. hair or glass parts in blister	Blister	Contamination/Foreign matter	Other	Yes	Yes	Medium	SCB (RoW) [d] SC Shiga (J) [e]
Foreign body, substance in the eye after injection. Silicon is supposed to be a foreign particle, although it is part of the PFS.	Syringe	Contamination/Foreign matter	Unspecified substance in eye after injection	Yes	Yes	Medium	2 mg: BD or Vetter [c] 8 mg: Vetter
Foreign particles in syringe/product contact	Syringe	Contamination/Foreign matter	Particles *or* Other	Yes	Yes	Medium	Vetter
Mark/Spots on syringe tip	Syringe	Contamination/Foreign matter	Ink *or* Other	Yes	Yes	Medium	2 mg: BD 8 mg: Vetter

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Reported Complaints	Level 1	Level 2	Level 3	Picture Required	Sample Return	Initial Risk Class	Manufacturing Site / Where to return Sample
Syringe							
Dose line is missing	Syringe	Malfunction	Dose line missing	Yes	Yes	Mediumor Low (not used)	2 mg: BD 8 mg: N/A
Dose line smear	Syringe	Appearance /Product characteristics	Dose line smear	Yes	Yes	Low	2 mg: BD 8 mg: N/A
Scratch on glass barrels	Syringe	Appearance /Product characteristics	Scratch on glass barrel *or* Other	Yes	Yes	Low	2 mg: BD 8 mg: SCB (RoW)/ SC Shiga (J)/Vetter
Silicon oil ring in the syringe	Syringe	Appearance /Product characteristics	Spots, changed or heterogenous appearance	Yes	Yes	Low	2 mg: N/A 8 mg: SCB (RoW) / SC Shiga (J)
Broken Syringe in an unopened package	Syringe	Damage	Pack intact	Yes	Yes	Low	SCB (RoW) SC Shiga (J)
Broken Tip	Syringe	Damage	Syringe Tip Breakage	Yes	Upon RQU request	Low (Medium [b])	2 mg: SCB (RoW)/ SC Shiga (J)/Vetter /BD 8 mg: SCB (RoW)/ SC Shiga (J)/Vetter

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Reported Complaints	Level 1	Level 2	Level 3	Picture Required	Sample Return	Initial Risk Class	Manufacturing Site / Where to return Sample
Scratched Tip	Syringe	Damage	Syringe Tip scratched	Yes	Yes	Low (Medium if used)	2 mg: SCB/SC Shiga (J) /Vetter/BD 8 mg: SCB/Vetter
Scratched Tip Cap	Syringe	Damage	Syringe Tip Cap scratched	Yes	Yes	Low	2 mg: SCB (RoW)/ SC Shiga (J)/Vetter /BD 8 mg: SCB/Vetter
Cracked Luer-Lock	Syringe	Damage	Luer-Lock cracked	Yes	Yes	Low (Medium [b])	2 mg: SCB (RoW)/SC Shiga (J)/Vetter/ BD 8 mg: SCB (RoW)/ SC Shiga (J)/Vetter
Broken Luer-Lock	Syringe	Damage	Luer-Lock Adapter wings deformed	Yes	Yes	Low	2 mg: SCB/SC Shiga (J)/Vetter/ BD 8 mg: SCB (RoW)/ SC Shiga (J)/Vetter

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Reported Complaints	Level 1	Level 2	Level 3	Picture Required	Sample Return	Initial Risk Class	Manufacturing Site / Where to return Sample
Luer lock loose (not broken)	Syringe	Damage	Luer-Lock loose	Yes	Yes	Low (Medium [b])	2 mg: SCB (RoW)/SC Shiga (J)/Vetter/ BD 8 mg: SCB (RoW) / SC Shiga (J)/Vetter
Loose open cap see	Syringe	Damage	Cap open/loose	Yes	Yes	Low (Medium if used)	2 mg: SCB (RoW)/SC Shiga (J)/Vetter/ BD 8 mg: SCB (RoW)/ SC Shiga (J)/Vetter
Syringe Leakage from unknown source	Syringe	Leakage	Location unknown / other	Yes	Yes	Low (Medium [b])	2 mg SCB (RoW)/SC Shiga (J)/Vetter/ BD 8 mg: SCB (RoW)/ SC Shiga (J)/Vetter
Flange breakage/ Finger Grip breakage	Syringe	Damage	Flange Breakage	Yes	Yes (to be sent to SCB)	Low (Medium[b])	2 mg: SCB (RoW) SC Shiga (J)

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Reported Complaints	Level 1	Level 2	Level 3	Picture Required	Sample Return	Initial Risk Class	Manufacturing Site / Where to return Sample
							8 mg: SCB (RoW) / SC Shiga (J)
Detached finger plate	Syringe	Damage	Finger plate detached	Yes	Yes	Low	2 mg: SCB (RoW) [d] SC Shiga (J) [e] 8 mg: SCB (RoW) [d] / SC Shiga (J) [e]
Broken, defect plunger 8mg: Defect / Loose Plunger Guide or Plunger Rod	Syringe	Damage	Plunger breakage *or* Plunger defect	Yes	Yes	Low (Medium[b])	2 mg: SCB (RoW) [d] SC Shiga (J) [e] 8 mg: (RoW) [d]/ SC Shiga (J) [e]
Use Errors/Handling Issues (may be included as Use Error (UE) or Complaint)							
Difficulties to move the plunger or align with the plunger slot (setting the dose) / Plunger resistance	Syringe	Handling Issue	Plunger mobility	No	Yes	Low	2 mg: SCB (RoW) SC Shiga (J) 8 mg: SCB (RoW) / SC Shiga (J)
Difficulties to remove cap	Syringe	Handling Issue	Handling difficult or impossible	No	Yes	Low	2 mg: SCB (RoW) SC Shiga (J)/BD 8 mg: SCB (RoW) / SC Shiga (J)/

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Reported Complaints	Level 1	Level 2	Level 3	Picture Required	Sample Return	Initial Risk Class	Manufacturing Site / Where to return Sample
8mg: OcuClick activation issue	Syringe	Handling issue	Plunger Mobility	No	Yes	Low	8 mg: SCB (RoW) [d] / SC Shiga (J) [e]
8 mg: Difficult to remove Syringe from Blister pack	Blister	Handling issue	Syringe difficult to remove	Yes	Yes	Low	SCB (RoW) [d] SC Shiga (J) [e]
8 mg: Difficult to be removed Tyvek foil	Blister	Handling issue	Difficult to open	Yes	Yes	Low	SCB (RoW) [d] SC Shiga (J) [e]

a If it is reported a serious incident by PV it must be categorized as 'Medium'. The PV evaluation is documented in the reporting form sheet from PV (RD-SOP-1227 - PTC request template).

b Decision based on specific case; Include 'Medium' only if it is confirmed that breakage happened during intravitreal injection (needle already in the eye) and not during preparation prior injection

c Check with RQU to which manufacturing site sample must be sent

d RQU = SC Berlin (DE06), RQU Responsible person: Amelie König

e RQU = SC Shiga (JP01), RQU Responsible person: Kunizawa, Keiji (gotkd)

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Table 2: Use Error (UE)/ Customer Satisfaction Issue (CSI): Guidance on initial error coding, sample/pictures return and affected Manufacturing Sites (not all inclusive) / Not Applicable for 8mg PFS (OcuClick)

Reported Use Errors (UE)/ Customer Satisfaction Issues (CSI)	Criteria	Error Code Level 1	Error Code Level 2	Error Code Level 3	Picture Required	Sample Return	Initial Risk Class	Manufacturing Site
Water/condensation in the blister	Without associated Adverse Event (AE) and reference to any other defect	Blister	Appearance/ Product Characteristics	Condensation/water	No*	No*	Low	SCB (RoW) [d] SC Shiga (J)
Air bubbles in solution	Without associated Adverse Event (AE) and reference to any other defect e.g. underfilling	Solution	Appearance/ Product Characteristics	Bubbles	No*	No*	Low	Vetter

*Picture/sample is only required if an investigation is needed i.e. if an adverse event is associated or any other defect type is reported

Note: RQU will continue to periodically monitor and trend condensation in blister and air bubbles complaints for Eylea PFS.

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3. Link to Eylea PFS Defect Catalogue / Not All Defects are applicable for Eylea 8 mg PFS (OcuClick)

Eylea PFS Catalogue

4. Shipping Addresses

Note: For 2 mg PFS please contact RQU if not clear where sample must be shipped!
For 8 mg PFS (OcuClick) please ship sample if available / required for investigation to RQU

Manufacturing site	Address
Supply Center Berlin (SCB) 2 mg PFS / 8 mg PFS (OcuClick)	All Complaints /UIs aside suspected falsification / counterfeit Julia Koall Bayer AG, Product Supply, Pharmaceuticals Quality Assurance 1 Müllerstrasse 178, 13353 Berlin, Germany Building M283, Room 203
	Suspected falsification / counterfeit cases (Prior shipping always inform & align with Julia Koall **Samples should be sent to QC Berlin at 2-8 °C (cool condition).** Marco König or Marco Hofsommer Bayer AG, Product Supply, Pharmaceuticals Quality Control 4 Building M232, 00/007 13353 Berlin Germany
Supply Center Shiga (J) 2 mg PFS / 8 mg PFS (OcuClick)	Mutsuhiro Okabe Bayer Yakuhin, Ltd. 121-1, Toriino, Koka-cho, Koka-shi, Shiga 520-3493 Japan
Becton Dickinson (BD) 2 mg PFS only	Armande Acolatse BD Medical - Pharmaceutical Systems ZI des Iles - 11 rue Aristide Berges, BP 4, 38801 Le Pont de Claix Cedex, France tel: +33 (0)4 76 68 33 61 fax: +33 (0)4 76 68 37 88
Vetter 2 mg PFS / 8 mg PFS (OcuClick)	Vetter Pharma-Fertigung GmbH & Co. KG Complaints/Reklamationen RVM Helmut-Vetter-Straße 10 88213 Ravensburg Germany
Phillips Medisize (supplier of OcuClick components: Finger flange + Plunger rod)	N/A, sample hast to be sent to Supply center Berlin / Supply center Shiga for investigation, If applicable, SCB / Supply Center Shiga will send the sample to the supplier.
West (supplier of plunger stopper) or Stevanato (supplier of empty 0.5 ml 'Ompi Alba' glass syringes)	N/A, sample hast to be sent to Vetter, If applicable, Vetter will send the sample to the supplier.

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Abbreviations: BD = Becton Dickinson, PFS= Prefilled Syringe; CQU = Country Quality Unit; GBS= Global Business services; J = Japan; SCB = Supply Center Berlin, IOP = intraocular pressure; IFU = Instruction For Use

Note: introduced changes are in blue

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